ALTAGETHER EVENT PLAN

Potluck Dinner

EFFORT: ●●○ COST: ●○○ CASSEROLE DISHES: ●●●



Invite neighbors to bring a dish, set out a few tables, and let dinner do the rest. It can be as simple or elaborate as your neighborhood wants to make it.

HOW TO PLAN:

2 weeks out

Pick a date, time, and location. A backyard, driveway, community space, or even a closed-off section of a quiet street can work.

Decide whether you want people to sign up for dishes ahead of time or just bring whatever they like.

1 week out

Send invitations and ask each household to bring a dish, dessert, or drink to share if they're able. It's helpful to ask a few people in advance to make sure you have some main dishes, sides, and desserts represented.

Figure out tables and seating. Ask neighbors to bring folding chairs if needed.

Day of

Set out tables for food and drinks. Have plates, cups, utensils, napkins, water, and a few serving utensils ready.

Put out a marker and some simple labels so people can write the name of their dish and note anything neighbors should know about it.

After

Do a quick cleanup, note who came, and follow up on anything that surfaced during the evening.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED:

- ☐ Folding tables*
- ☐ A few folding chairs*
- ☐ Plates, cups, napkins, and utensils
- ☐ Serving utensils
- ☐ Water and ice
- ☐ Food labels or index cards + marker
- ☐ Trash and recycling bags
- ☐ Optional: small speaker or string lights

TIPS:

- ✔ Don't feel like you need to provide the meal yourself. The whole point is that everyone contributes a little.
- ✔ Give people an easy out: "Bring something if you can, but please come either way." You don't want someone skipping dinner because they didn't have time to cook.
- ✔ If you're worried about ending up with twelve desserts and no dinner, ask a handful of neighbors ahead of time to claim broad categories like main dish, side, dessert, or drinks.
- ✔ Keep the setup communal. Long tables or clusters of chairs make it easier for people who don't already know one another to mingle.
- ✔ Altagether will reimburse for needed supplies! Save receipts and submit a request.

SAMPLE INVITATIONS:

LONG VERSION

Hi neighbors! We're getting together for a neighborhood potluck dinner and would love to have you join us.

Bring a favorite dish, side, dessert, or drink to share if you can. Homemade, store-bought, or picked up on the way is all completely welcome. And if bringing something is a hassle, just bring yourself.

[Day, Date] from [Time]
[Location / Address]

We'll put everything on the table and have dinner together. Bring the family, bring a neighbor, and come hungry. All ages are welcome. Hope to see you there!

SHORT VERSION

Hi neighbors! Potluck dinner at [location] this [day] at [time]. Bring a dish, dessert, or drink to share if you can, but please come either way. All ages welcome. Hope to see you there!

[Address]

